



CITY OF
Crystal Lake
ILLINOIS

September 15, 2025

Mr. Jack Billimack
227 Illinois Street
Crystal Lake, IL 60014

Dear Mr. Billimack,

Thank you for your recent email in which you have requested a review of various articles of the City Code, Unified Development Ordinance (UDO), and 2018 International Fire Code (IFC) in reference to fire apparatus access on your block.

The 2018 IFC would not directly apply in this case. The IFC does not directly pertain to one and two-family dwellings. Rather, one and two-family dwellings are covered under the International Residential Code (IRC). However, the IFC may be applied to large, single-family developments, typically consisting of 31 or more single-family residential units where accessibility and water supply may be of concern.

Further your email appears to be referencing the provisions of Section A-400(D)(6)(a) of the Unified Development Ordinance (your email appears to have inadvertently referenced Subsection (E)(6)). The standards set forth in A-400(D)(6)(a) of the UDO are only applicable to developments "which do not have frontage on a public street." Even if provisions of the IFC were to be deemed applicable, The Vail Addition, including Illinois Street, which was platted in the early 1900s, is served by residential paved streets that meet the intent of the Fire Department Access Road. The IFC requires that a development exceeding 30 units shall be provided with two separate access roads. In this case, access to the Vail Addition includes Main Street, Ellsworth Street, Illinois Street, Glen Avenue, Sherman Street, and Route 176, all with fire hydrant access and availability. Consequently, no other access road is required to serve the homes on Illinois Street.

Furthermore, the unpaved and unimproved alley in question does not meet the definition of a Fire Department Access Road and would not be treated as such by the Fire Rescue Department.

If you have any additional questions, please feel free to contact the City at (815) 459-2020 or via email to me at csnyder@crystallake.org.

Sincerely,

Craig Snyder
Fire Rescue Chief
City of Crystal Lake

Cc: Eric Helm, City Manager